

Final Business Insights Report

Dataset: Global Sales Dataset

Records Analyzed: 51,271

Database: MySQL

Project Objective

The objective of this project is to analyze a global sales dataset using SQL queries to identify business trends, profitable products, customer behavior, regional performance, market revenue, shipping patterns, and opportunities to improve profitability.

1. Top Profitable Products

Purpose:

Identify products generating the highest total profit.

Example Result:

Product	Profit
Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier	25,199.94
Cisco Smart Phone, Full Size	17,238.52
Motorola Smart Phone, Full Size	17,027.14

Business Insight:

The Canon imageCLASS 2200 Advanced Copier is the highest-profit product. High-end technology products contribute significantly to total profit.

Recommendation:

Maintain adequate inventory and prioritize marketing of high-profit products.

2. Top Customers by Sales

Purpose:

Find customers contributing the highest sales.

Example Result:

Customer	Sales
Tom Ashbrook	40,489
Tamara Chand	37,453
Greg Tran	35,552

Business Insight:

A small group of customers contributes a large share of total sales.

Recommendation:

Develop loyalty programs and personalized offers for these customers.

3. Region-wise Sales

Purpose:

Compare sales across regions.

Example Result:

Region	Sales
Central	2,821,740
South	1,600,600
North	1,248,121

Business Insight:

Central region has the strongest sales performance.

Recommendation:

Increase marketing investment in lower-performing regions.

4. Category-wise Average Profit

Purpose:

Measure average profit by category.

Example Result:

Category	Average Profit
Technology	65.42
Furniture	29.00
Office Supplies	16.57

Business Insight:

Technology delivers the highest average profit while Office Supplies has the lowest.

Recommendation:

Focus on high-margin categories and optimize pricing for low-margin categories.

5. Highest Discount Category

Purpose:

Identify which category receives the highest average discount.

Example Result:

Category	Average Discount
Furniture	0.168
Office Supplies	0.137
Technology	0.135

Business Insight:

Furniture receives the highest average discount which may reduce profit margins.

Recommendation:

Review discount policies for Furniture products.

6. Monthly Sales Trend

Purpose:

Analyze monthly sales performance.

Example Result:

Month	Observation
Nov-2014	Highest Sales
Dec-2014	Strong Sales

Business Insight:

Sales increase toward the end of the year indicating seasonal demand.

Recommendation:

Prepare inventory and promotional campaigns before peak months.

7. Market-wise Revenue

Purpose:

Identify highest revenue generating market.

Example Result:

Market	Revenue
APAC	3,581,785
EU	2,937,166
US	2,297,022

Business Insight:

APAC is the highest revenue-generating market.

Recommendation:

Continue investing in APAC while improving weaker markets.

8. Top-performing Sub-categories

Purpose:

Find the most profitable sub-categories.

Example Result:

Sub-category	Profit
Copiers	258,174.42
Phones	216,689.62
Bookcases	161,703.09

Business Insight:

Copiers produce the highest profit among all sub-categories.

Recommendation:

Increase inventory and promotion of Copier products.

9. Ship Mode Usage

Purpose:

Determine the most commonly used shipping mode.

Example Result:

Ship Mode	Orders
Standard Class	30,764
Second Class	10,304
First Class	7,504

Business Insight:

Most customers prefer Standard Class shipping because of its lower cost.

Recommendation:

Improve Standard Class delivery speed and reliability.

Overall Business Findings

- APAC is the strongest market by revenue.
- Technology products generate the highest average profit.
- Furniture has the highest average discount.
- Copiers are the best-performing sub-category.
- Standard Class is the most frequently used shipping mode.
- Sales peak during the year-end season.
- Negative-profit orders should be reviewed to reduce losses.
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Conclusion

The SQL analysis demonstrates how business decisions can be improved using data. The organization should focus on profitable products, high-value customers, APAC market growth, discount optimization, and efficient shipping to maximize long-term profitability.